



Felfela & The Quiet Storm

By Radwa Abdelmonaem

Alya was a gentle little girl who lived by the sea. Her companion was a small dog named **Felfela**, whose fur was soft as clouds.

Alya considered Felfela her best friend since day1 when she found her with a body full of scars and weak from hunger and lack of water. She gave her everything food, toys, walks under the sun, and a home where silence meant safety, not fear.



Felfela was cared for, but her heart carried old wounds. Long before Alya, she had lived in places where cruelty grew like weeds. And though Alya gave her warmth, Felfela often trembled in the quiet of night. As soon as her body felt safe enough to rest, her memories rose like ghosts, whispering: “What if Alya leaves me? What if she turns like the others did? Wouldn’t that pain cut deeper than before?”



When Alya saw her trembling, she tried everything. She brought cool water, switched on Felfela's favorite lamp, closed the windows to keep out the noise. But still, Felfela sat in silence, chest heaving, eyes wet.



Frustration grew in Alya's chest.



"Why are you not happy, why are you ungrateful?" she shouted. "I've given you everything why can't you just be cheerful at night why can't you sleep? What wrong did I do? Why all what I'm doing to you is not enough to relax and sleep"

Felfela broke apart. She Jumped to the doo and started running so fast Alya could barely keep up, clutching the leash as if it were a lifeline, trying desperately not to lose Felfela.



They ran through the dark streets until suddenly Felfela stopped before a big house with a Farm.



Felfela Showed Alya her old Prison where they used to keep her without any Food or Water



From the doorway, people stepped out faces Alya had never seen but Felfela clearly remembered. One of them sneered "Ah, little mutt, you missed the beatings? You missed carrying our heavy loads until you dropped?"

Another laughed, "What did you do to this poor girl?" They said pointing at Alya adding, "We should lock you out again no food, no water, just the lesson you deserve."



Alya's heart froze. She pulled Felfela close, shielding her small body with her arms. "Don't worry I'm with you nobody can hurt you while I'm here"



Only then did Alya understand. Felfela wasn't ungrateful. She was terrified. The kindness Alya gave her was so precious that the thought of losing it was unbearable. Safety itself had become a fragile dream that Felfela never trusted to last.



Alya knelt down, holding Felfela gently and Said:



"Listen to me, my favorite friend. I will never hurt you. I will never throw you away. Every time you feel the storm of Fears rise again don't be quiet, don't live in it alone. Just come to me and I will hug you and remind you: you are safe here, you belong here, and you are loved."

Felfela trembled, tears in her eyes, but this time, when she leaned against Alya's chest, her breathing slowly eased. The ghosts of her past did not vanish, but for the first time, they stepped back into the shadows.



And together, under the quiet night sky, Felfela and Alya walked home not free from storms, but learning how to face them side by side.

In that moment, Alya understood something she had never seen before. Food, water, toys, long walks, and even a safe roof were not enough to heal Felfela's heart. Safety was more than shelter, more than comfort, it was a language of love that could reach the invisible scars no one else could see.

Felfela's fears were thieves, stealing rest from her nights and joy from her days. What Felfela needed was not only care, but patience gentle words, steady presence, and the promise that no storm would drive Alya away.

So Alya whispered again, holding her close:

"You are safe, you are loved, and I will remind you of this whenever any storm of fears haunt you, until your heart believes it."

And though the shadows of the past still lingered, Felfela closed her eyes and rested in Alya's arms for the first time not only cared for, but beginning to feel safe within her own skin.

THE END.